

MATH 223: Linear Algebra

W.R.YCH.

January 5th, 2026

Abstract

These are personal lecture notes for MATH 223: Linear Algebra, McGill University, Winter 2026. Topics covered include complex numbers, abstract vector spaces, subspaces, basis and dimension, linear transformations, isomorphisms, change of basis, eigenvalues and diagonalization, and inner product spaces including the spectral theorem and Gram-Schmidt orthonormalization. Definitions, theorems, and worked examples are included throughout, along with a complete problem and solution set.

Contents

1	Introduction	1
2	Prerequisite Knowledge	1
2.1	Introduction to Proof	1
2.1.1	Direct Proof	1
2.1.2	Proof by Contradiction	1
2.1.3	Proof by Contrapositive	2
2.2	Notation	2
2.2.1	Sets	2
2.2.2	Symbols	2
2.3	Complex Numbers	3
2.3.1	Definition and the Fundamental Theorem of Algebra	3
2.3.2	Arithmetic Operations	3
2.3.3	Complex Conjugate	3
2.3.4	Geometric Interpretation and Modulus	4
2.3.5	Polar Coordinates and Polar Form	4
2.3.6	Roots in $\mathbb{C}$	5
2.3.7	Hermiticity	5
2.4	Basic Algebraic Structures	6
2.4.1	Sets with Multiplication	6
2.4.2	Invertibility	6
2.4.3	Rings	8
2.4.4	Fields	8
3	Vector Spaces	8
3.1	Vectors and Linear Combinations	9
3.2	Span and Standard Basis	10
3.2.1	Span	10
3.2.2	Span in $\mathbb{C}^n$	11
3.2.3	Standard Basis	12
3.3	Examples of Vector Spaces	12
3.3.1	Coordinate Spaces	12
3.3.2	Polynomial Spaces	12
3.3.3	Matrix Spaces	13
3.3.4	Function Spaces	13
3.4	Subspaces	14
3.4.1	Definition and the Subspace Criterion	14
3.4.2	Membership in a Span	15
3.4.3	Operations on Subspaces	15
3.4.4	Direct Sums	16

4	Basis and Dimension	16
4.1	Finite Dimensional Spaces	16
4.2	Linear Independence	17
4.3	Basis	17
4.3.1	Definition and the Main Basis Theorem	17
4.3.2	Finding a Basis	18
4.3.3	Proving a Set Forms a Basis	19
4.3.4	Basis Extension and Extraction	19
4.4	Coordinates and Change of Basis	20
4.4.1	Coordinate Vectors	20
4.4.2	Direct Sum Decompositions and Dimension Formulas	21
5	Linear Transformations	21
5.1	Functions: Basic Definitions	21
5.1.1	Composition and Inverses	22
5.2	Linear Maps	22
5.2.1	Main Examples of Linear Maps	22
5.2.2	Defining a Linear Map by its Action on a Basis	24
5.3	Kernel and Image	24
5.3.1	Rank-Nullity Theorem	24
5.3.2	Examples of Kernel and Image	25
5.4	Matrix of a Linear Transformation	25
6	Isomorphisms and Coordinates	26
6.1	The Canonical Isomorphism	26
6.2	Change of Basis	27
6.2.1	Change of Basis Matrix	27
6.2.2	Change of Basis Formula	27
7	Diagonalization	28
7.1	Eigenvalues and Eigenvectors	28
7.2	The Characteristic Polynomial	28
7.3	Algebraic and Geometric Multiplicity	28
7.4	Diagonalization	29
7.5	Similar Matrices	30
8	Inner Product Spaces	30
8.1	Real Inner Products	30
8.2	Complex inner products	32
8.3	Cauchy-Schwarz Inequality	32
8.4	Orthonormal Bases	33
8.5	Symmetric Matrices Are Diagonalizable	34
8.6	Orthogonal Matrices in Dimension 2	35
8.7	Isomorphism Theorem For Inner Product Spaces	35
8.8	Gram-Schmidt Orthonormalization	35

9	Appendix	36
9.1	Proof: Standard Basis is a Basis	36
10	Solutions	36
11	Useful Links	38

1 Introduction

These notes were written for MATH 223 (Linear Algebra) at McGill University, Winter 2026.

Grading scheme:

20% assignments + 20% midterm + 60% final or 20% assignments + 80% final
whichever is higher.

2 Prerequisite Knowledge

2.1 Introduction to Proof

2.1.1 Direct Proof

The basic idea of a direct proof of $P \implies Q$ is:

1. Assume P is true,
2. Use P to show that Q is true (the hard part).

Example. *An integer number n is odd if and only if there exists an integer k such that $n = 2k + 1$.*

Proof. Assume a, b are consecutive integers, meaning $b = a + 1$. So

$$a + b = a + (a + 1) = 2a + 1.$$

Thus b is odd if and only if a is odd. □

2.1.2 Proof by Contradiction

The idea is that a proposition is either true or false, but not both. We get a contradiction when we can show a statement is both true and false, showing our initial assumptions are inconsistent. We use this to show $P \implies Q$ by assuming both P and not Q are simultaneously true and deriving a contradiction.

Example. *An integer number n is odd if and only if there exists an integer k such that $n = 2k + 1$.*

Proof. Assume a and b are consecutive integers. Assume that $(a + b)$ is not odd. If $(a + b)$ is not odd, then no integer k such that $(a + b) = 2k + 1$. But $a + b = a + (a + 1) = 2a + 1$. We have shown that $(a + b) \neq 2k + 1$ but $(a + b) = 2a + 1$, a contradiction. □

2.1.3 Proof by Contrapositive

The idea is to prove $P \implies Q$ by instead proving $\text{not } Q \implies \text{not } P$.

Example. If n^2 is even, then n is even.

Proof. We show the contrapositive: if n is odd, then n^2 is odd. Assume n is odd, $\exists k_1 \in \mathbb{Z}, n = 2k_1 + 1$. So

$$n^2 = (2k_1 + 1)^2 = 4k_1^2 + 4k_1 + 1 = 2(2k_1^2 + 2k_1) + 1.$$

Let $k_2 = 2k_1^2 + 2k_1$. Then $n^2 = 2k_2 + 1$, so n^2 is odd. $\square$

2.2 Notation

2.2.1 Sets

Sets are a grouping of objects.

Set	Meaning	Examples
$\mathbb{N}$	The set of natural numbers	$(0, 1, 2, 3, \dots)$
$\mathbb{Z}$	The set of integers	$(\dots, -3, -2, -1, 0, 1, 2, 3, \dots)$
$\mathbb{Q}$	The set of rational numbers	$\mathbb{Q} = \frac{a}{b} \mid \forall a, b \in \mathbb{Z} \text{ and } b \neq 0$
$\mathbb{R}$	The set of all rational and all irrational numbers	$(\dots, -1, 0, \frac{1}{4}, 1, 1000, \dots)$
$\mathbb{C}$	The set of all complex numbers	$\mathbb{C} = \{x + iy \mid x, y \in \mathbb{R} \text{ and } i \subseteq \sqrt{-1}\}.$

We have the following relationships between sets:

$$\mathbb{N} \subseteq \mathbb{Z} \subseteq \mathbb{Q} \subseteq \mathbb{R} \subseteq \mathbb{C}.$$

2.2.2 Symbols

Symbol	Meaning
$\subseteq$	is a subset of or equal to
$\subset$	is a strict subset of
$\in$	is an element of
$\forall$	for all
$\exists$	there exists
$\emptyset$	empty set
$\Rightarrow$	implies
$\Leftrightarrow$	if and only if
$\cong$	is isomorphic to ¹

¹is isomorphic to = structurally the same as.

2.3 Complex Numbers

2.3.1 Definition and the Fundamental Theorem of Algebra

Definition 1 (Complex Number). A complex number is of the form: $z = x + iy$ where $x, y \in \mathbb{R}$ and i is the imaginary unit $i = \sqrt{-1}$.

Theorem 1 (Fundamental Theorem of Algebra). The FTA states that any non-constant, single-variable polynomial² with complex coefficients has at least one root in $\mathbb{C}$.

Remark 1. If we have a polynomial f of degree n , then it has n roots, where each root can have a multiplicity³.

Example. $(x - 1)^2$ has degree 2 but only one root, which is 1, with multiplicity 2.

We can factorize a polynomial $f = a_n x^n + \dots + a_1 x + a_0$ as $f = a(x - z_1)(x - z_2) \dots (x - z_n)$, where z_i are the roots of f in $\mathbb{C}$.

2.3.2 Arithmetic Operations

We define the following operations on complex numbers $z = x + iy$ and $z' = x' + iy'$:

- Addition: $z + z' = (x + x') + i(y + y')$.
- Multiplication: $zz' = (xx' - yy') + i(xy' + yx')$.
- Inverse: $\frac{1}{z} = \frac{\bar{z}}{z\bar{z}} = \frac{x - iy}{x^2 + y^2} = \frac{x}{x^2 + y^2} + i \frac{-y}{x^2 + y^2}$.

Multiplying by a complex number z corresponds geometrically to:

$$\begin{cases} \text{a rotation by angle } \theta, \\ \text{a rescaling by factor } |z|. \end{cases}$$

2.3.3 Complex Conjugate

Definition 2 (Complex Conjugate). For $z = x + iy$, the complex conjugate is $\bar{z} = x - iy$.

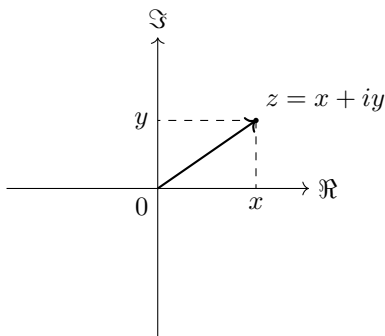
Basic properties:

- $\overline{\bar{z}} = z$
- $\overline{z + z'} = \bar{z} + \bar{z'}$
- $\overline{z \cdot z'} = \bar{z} \cdot \bar{z'}$

2.3.4 Geometric Interpretation and Modulus

Definition 3 (Geometric interpretation). *Every complex number $z = x + iy$ is identified with a point (x, y) in the complex plane:*

$$\mathbb{C} = \{x + iy \mid x, y \in \mathbb{R}\}.$$



Definition 4 (Modulus). *The modulus of z is*

$$|z| = \sqrt{z\bar{z}} = \sqrt{x^2 + y^2}.$$

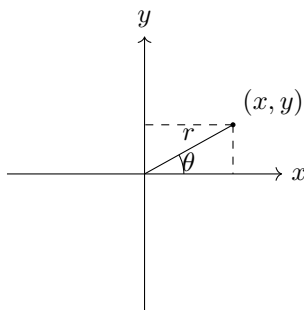
Geometrically, $|z|$ is the distance from the origin to (x, y) .

The unit circle in the complex plane can be written as:

$$S^1 = \{(x, y) \in \mathbb{R}^2 : x^2 + y^2 = 1\} = \{z \in \mathbb{C} : |z| = 1\}.$$

2.3.5 Polar Coordinates and Polar Form

Definition 5 (Polar coordinates). *Instead of (x, y) , a point can be described by polar coordinates (r, θ) , where r is the distance to the origin and θ is the angle with the positive x -axis.*



²A polynomial is a function such as $f = a_n x^n + a_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_1 x + a_0$ where $a_i \in \mathbb{R}$ or $\mathbb{C}$ and $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

³The multiplicity of a root represents how many times the root occurs in the polynomial.

So $x = r \cos \theta$ and $y = r \sin \theta$, with $r = |z|$.

Definition 6 (Euler's formula).

$$e^{i\theta} = \cos \theta + i \sin \theta. \quad (1)$$

Definition 7 (Polar and exponential form). If $z = x + iy$ with $r = \sqrt{x^2 + y^2}$, then $x = r \cos \theta$, $y = r \sin \theta$, so

$$z = r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta) = re^{i\theta}.$$

Definition 8 (Multiplication in polar form).

$$z = re^{i\theta}, \quad z' = r'e^{i\theta'} \implies zz' = rr'e^{i(\theta+\theta')}.$$

Example.

$$(1+i)^{32} = (\sqrt{2}e^{i\pi/4})^{32} = 2^{16}e^{i8\pi} = 2^{16}(\cos 8\pi + i \sin 8\pi) = 2^{16}.$$

2.3.6 Roots in $\mathbb{C}$

Definition 9 (n^{th} roots). For $z \in \mathbb{C}$, an n^{th} root of z is $w \in \mathbb{C}$ with $w^n = z$.

Example. If $z = re^{i\theta}$, the solutions of $w^n = z$ are

$$w_k = r^{1/n}e^{i(\theta+2\pi k)/n}, \quad k = 0, 1, \dots, n-1.$$

They are equally spaced on a circle of radius $r^{1/n}$ centered at the origin.

Definition 10 (Roots of unity). The n^{th} roots of unity are solutions of $w^n = 1$:

$$w_k = e^{i2\pi k/n}, \quad k = 0, 1, \dots, n-1.$$

They lie on the unit circle and are equally spaced.

2.3.7 Hermiticity

Definition 11 (Hermitian Matrix). A matrix $A \in M_n(\mathbb{C})$ is Hermitian if $A = A^*$, where $A^* = \overline{A}^T$. Equivalently,

$$a_{ij} = \overline{a_{ji}} \quad \forall i, j.$$

Example. $A = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 1+i \\ 1-i & 3 \end{pmatrix}$ is Hermitian since $A^* = A$.

Remark 2. All eigenvalues of a Hermitian matrix are real, and eigenvectors corresponding to distinct eigenvalues are orthogonal.

Problem 1 (Hermitian Matrix). Let $A, B \in M_n(\mathbb{C})$. Prove that $(AB)^* = B^*A^*$.

Definition 12 (Anti-Hermitian Matrix). A matrix $A \in M_n(\mathbb{C})$ is anti-Hermitian if $A = -A^*$, where $A^* = \overline{A}^T$. Equivalently,

$$a_{ij} = -\overline{a_{ji}} \quad \forall i, j.$$

Problem 2 (Hermiticity and Anti-Hermiticity). Prove that A is Hermitian iff iA is anti-Hermitian.

2.4 Basic Algebraic Structures

2.4.1 Sets with Multiplication

Definition 13 (Set with multiplication). *A set M is a set with multiplication if for any $a, b \in M$, the product $ab \in M$.*

Example. $M_2(\mathbb{C})$ (all 2×2 complex matrices) and $\mathbb{R}^* = \mathbb{R} \setminus \{0\}$ are sets with multiplication.

2.4.2 Invertibility

Definition 14 (Invertibility). *There are two methods of defining invertibility:*

- Let $A \in M_n(k)$. If there exists $B \in M_n(k)$ with $AB = I_n$ or $BA = I_n$, then A is invertible and $B = A^{-1}$. Here I_n is the $n \times n$ identity matrix⁴.
- Let $A \in M_n(k)$ with $\det(A) \neq 0$. Then the inverse of A is

$$A^{-1} = \frac{1}{\det(A)} \operatorname{adj}(A),$$

where $\operatorname{adj}(A)$ is the adjugate of A .

Definition 15 (Adjugate of a Matrix). *The adjugate of $A \in M_n(k)$ is the transpose of the cofactor matrix of A :*

$$\operatorname{adj}(A) = \operatorname{cof}(A)^t,$$

where cof is the cofactor matrix. For a 2×2 matrix this reduces to:

$$\operatorname{adj} \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} d & -b \\ -c & a \end{pmatrix}.$$

Definition 16 (Cofactor Matrix). *The cofactor matrix of $A \in M_n(k)$ is the matrix C whose (i, j) entry is the cofactor*

$$C_{ij} = (-1)^{i+j} M_{ij},$$

where M_{ij} is the determinant of the matrix obtained by deleting row i and column j from A . The sign pattern $(-1)^{i+j}$ is:

$$\begin{pmatrix} + & - & + & \cdots \\ - & + & - & \cdots \\ + & - & + & \cdots \\ \vdots & \vdots & \vdots & \ddots \end{pmatrix}.$$

⁴The identity matrix has 1s on its diagonal and 0s elsewhere.

Example. Let $A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 0 & 4 & 5 \\ 1 & 0 & 6 \end{pmatrix}$. The cofactors are:

$$\begin{aligned} C_{11} &= (+1) \det \begin{pmatrix} 4 & 5 \\ 0 & 6 \end{pmatrix} = 24, & C_{12} &= (-1) \det \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 5 \\ 1 & 6 \end{pmatrix} = 5, \\ C_{13} &= (+1) \det \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 4 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} = -4, & C_{21} &= (-1) \det \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 3 \\ 0 & 6 \end{pmatrix} = -12, \\ C_{22} &= (+1) \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 3 \\ 1 & 6 \end{pmatrix} = 3, & C_{23} &= (-1) \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} = 2, \\ C_{31} &= (+1) \det \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 3 \\ 4 & 5 \end{pmatrix} = -2, & C_{32} &= (-1) \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 3 \\ 0 & 5 \end{pmatrix} = -5, \\ C_{33} &= (+1) \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 0 & 4 \end{pmatrix} = 4. \end{aligned}$$

The cofactor matrix is

$$\text{cof}(A) = \begin{pmatrix} 24 & 5 & -4 \\ -12 & 3 & 2 \\ -2 & -5 & 4 \end{pmatrix}$$

Transposing the cofactor matrix to obtain the adjugate:

$$\text{adj}(A) = \begin{pmatrix} 24 & -12 & -2 \\ 5 & 3 & -5 \\ -4 & 2 & 4 \end{pmatrix}.$$

One can verify: $\det(A) = 22$, and indeed $A^{-1} = \frac{1}{22} \text{adj}(A)$.

Remark 3. If A is invertible, A^{-1} is unique⁵.

Example. $2 \in \mathbb{Z}$ is not invertible since $\frac{1}{2} \notin \mathbb{Z}$, but $2 \in \mathbb{R}$ is invertible since $\frac{1}{2} \in \mathbb{R}$.

Example. $1 + i \in \mathbb{C}$ is invertible: $\frac{1}{1+i} = \frac{1-i}{2} \in \mathbb{C}$.

Problem 3 (Invertibility). Show that if an inverse of A in M exists, then it is unique.

Problem 4 (Invertibility 2). Let K be a field. Prove that $\begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \in M_2(K)$ is not invertible.

⁵Unique: there is exactly one such element.

2.4.3 Rings

Definition 17 (Ring). A ring is a set R with addition and multiplication satisfying:

1. $(R, +)$ ⁶ is a commutative⁷ and associative⁸ group with zero ($\exists 0 \in R$) and additive inverses (every element has an additive inverse $-a$ with $a + (-a) = 0$). Essentially, R behaves like $\mathbb{Z}$ under addition.
2. Multiplication is associative with identity 1. This means $(ab)c = a(bc)$ for all $a, b, c \in R$, and there exists $1 \in R$ with $1 \cdot a = a \cdot 1 = a$. Note that multiplication need not be commutative (i.e., ab may not equal ba), and nonzero elements need not have multiplicative inverses.
3. Distributivity: $a(b + c) = ab + ac$ and $(a + b)c = ac + bc$.

Example. $(\mathbb{Z}, +, \cdot)$ is a ring: it is closed under addition and multiplication, has zero element and additive inverses, multiplication is associative with identity 1, and multiplication distributes over addition.

2.4.4 Fields

Definition 18 (Field). A field is a ring ¹⁷ in which every nonzero element has a multiplicative inverse.

Example. $(\mathbb{Q}, +, \cdot)$ is a field: it is a ring, and every nonzero $q \in \mathbb{Q}$ has $q^{-1} \in \mathbb{Q}$ with $q \cdot q^{-1} = 1$.

Remark 4. $\mathbb{Z}$ is a ring but not a field: for example, there is no integer x with $2x = 1$.

3 Vector Spaces

Definition 19 (Vector Space). Let k be a field. A vector space over k is a set V with addition and scalar multiplication satisfying:

1. Closure under addition: $v_1 + v_2 \in V$
2. Commutativity: $v_1 + v_2 = v_2 + v_1$
3. Associativity: $(v_1 + v_2) + v_3 = v_1 + (v_2 + v_3)$
4. Zero vector: $\exists 0 \in V$ with $v + 0 = v$
5. Additive inverses: $\forall v \in V, \exists -v \in V$ with $v + (-v) = 0$

⁶The notation $(R, +)$ means the set R equipped with the operation $+$. It specifies which operation we are talking about, since R has both $+$ and $\times$ defined on it.

⁷ $a + b = b + a$.

⁸ $a + (b + c) = (a + b) + c$.

6. Closure under scalar multiplication: $\lambda v \in V$
7. Multiplication associativity: $\lambda(\mu v) = (\lambda\mu)v$
8. Identity: $1 \cdot v = v$
9. Distributivity over vectors: $\lambda(v_1 + v_2) = \lambda v_1 + \lambda v_2$
10. Distributivity over scalars: $(\lambda + \mu)v = \lambda v + \mu v$

Remark 5. The axioms for a ring and a vector space look similar because they share the same additive structure. The key difference is that a ring has an internal multiplication (elements of R multiply each other), whereas a vector space has an external scalar multiplication (elements of V are scaled by elements of a separate field k). A field is then just a ring where every nonzero element also has a multiplicative inverse, which is exactly what makes it a suitable set of scalars for a vector space.

Remark 6. We often say *abstract vector space* to emphasize that elements of V can be any objects (functions, tensors, matrices, etc.) satisfying these axioms — not just arrows or tuples in $\mathbb{R}^n$.

Example (Non-standard vector space). Let $V = \{x \in \mathbb{R} : x > 0\}$ be the set of positive reals, with operations:

$$u \oplus v := uv \quad (\text{“addition” is multiplication}), \quad \lambda \odot u := u^\lambda \quad (\text{“scalar mult” is exponentiation}).$$

This looks nothing like a normal vector space, so we need to identify what the zero vector and additive inverses are before checking the axioms.

Zero vector. We need $u \oplus 0_V = u$, i.e., $u \cdot 0_V = u$, so $0_V = 1$.

Additive inverse. We need $u \oplus (-u) = 0_V = 1$, i.e., $u \cdot (-u) = 1$, so $(-u) = 1/u$.

Key axioms. The non-obvious ones to check are:

- Distributivity over scalars: $(\lambda + \mu) \odot u = u^{\lambda + \mu} = u^\lambda \cdot u^\mu = (\lambda \odot u) \oplus (\mu \odot u)$.
✓
- Distributivity over vectors: $\lambda \odot (u \oplus v) = (uv)^\lambda = u^\lambda v^\lambda = (\lambda \odot u) \oplus (\lambda \odot v)$.
✓
- Scalar compatibility: $\lambda \odot (\mu \odot u) = \lambda \odot (u^\mu) = (u^\mu)^\lambda = u^{\lambda\mu} = (\lambda\mu) \odot u$. ✓

All 10 axioms hold, so V is a vector space. The reason this works is that V is really just $\mathbb{R}$ in disguise: the map $\varphi : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow V$, $x \mapsto e^x$ converts ordinary addition into multiplication and ordinary scalar multiplication into exponentiation.

3.1 Vectors and Linear Combinations

Vector operations in $\mathbb{R}^n$ are defined component-wise:

- Addition: $\begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ \vdots \\ x_n \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} y_1 \\ \vdots \\ y_n \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} x_1 + y_1 \\ \vdots \\ x_n + y_n \end{pmatrix}.$
- Scalar multiplication: $\lambda \begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ \vdots \\ x_n \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \lambda x_1 \\ \vdots \\ \lambda x_n \end{pmatrix},$ where $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}.$

Definition 20 (Linear combination). *A linear combination of $v_1, \dots, v_n$ is $v = \lambda_1 v_1 + \dots + \lambda_n v_n$ for scalars $\lambda_i \in k.$*

Example (Computing a linear combination). *Let $v_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}$ and $v_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix}.$*

Express $v = \begin{pmatrix} 7 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix}$ as a linear combination of v_1 and $v_2.$

We need $\lambda_1, \lambda_2 \in \mathbb{R}$ such that $\lambda_1 v_1 + \lambda_2 v_2 = v,$ i.e.,

$$\lambda_1 \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix} + \lambda_2 \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 7 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix} \implies \begin{cases} \lambda_1 + 3\lambda_2 = 7 \\ 2\lambda_1 - \lambda_2 = 3. \end{cases}$$

From the second equation $\lambda_2 = 2\lambda_1 - 3.$ Substituting: $\lambda_1 + 3(2\lambda_1 - 3) = 7 \implies 7\lambda_1 = 16 \implies \lambda_1 = \frac{16}{7}, \lambda_2 = \frac{11}{7}.$ Hence

$$v = \frac{16}{7}v_1 + \frac{11}{7}v_2.$$

3.2 Span and Standard Basis

3.2.1 Span

Definition 21 (Span). *Let $A \subset \mathbb{R}^n.$ The span of A is the set of all linear combinations of elements of $A.$ If $A = \{v_1, \dots, v_k\},$ then*

$$\text{span}(A) = \{\lambda_1 v_1 + \dots + \lambda_k v_k : \lambda_i \in \mathbb{R}\}.$$

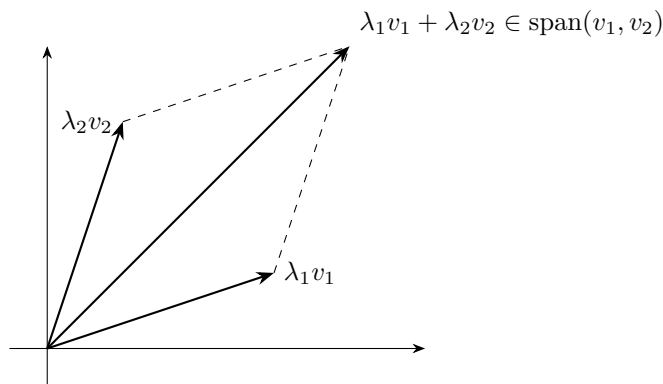
The span describes all points reachable by scaling and adding the given vectors: it can be a line, plane, or higher-dimensional subspace depending on the vectors.

Remark 7. *If $A = \{v\} \subset \mathbb{R}^2$ with $v \neq 0,$ then $\text{span}(v) = \{\lambda v : \lambda \in \mathbb{R}\}$ is the line through the origin in the direction of $v.$*

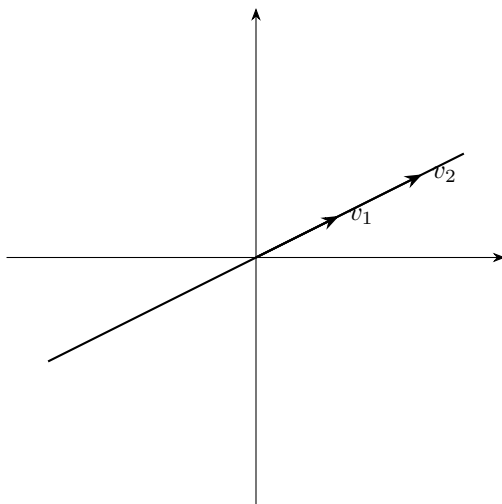
Example. $\text{span}\left(\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}\right) = \left\{t \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \mid t \in \mathbb{R}\right\}$ is a line in $\mathbb{R}^2.$

Problem 5 (Span). *Let $v_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, v_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix}.$ Find $\text{span}(v_1, v_2).$*

For two linearly independent vectors $v_1, v_2 \in \mathbb{R}^2,$ any vector in $\text{span}(v_1, v_2)$ has the form $\lambda_1 v_1 + \lambda_2 v_2:$



If v_1 and v_2 are linearly dependent ($v_1 = \lambda v_2$), then $\text{span}(v_1, v_2)$ is just a line:



Problem 6 (Span 2). *Determine whether the first vector is in the span of the others. If so, write it as a linear combination.*

$$u = (2, 10, 7, 0), \quad u_1 = (3, 10, 7, 0), \quad u_2 = (1, 3, -2, 0), \quad u_3 = (2, 8, 1, 0); \quad u, u_i \in \mathbb{R}^4.$$

3.2.2 Span in $\mathbb{C}^n$

Definition 22 (Span over $\mathbb{C}$).

$$\text{span}_{\mathbb{C}}(v_1, \dots, v_n) = \{\lambda_1 v_1 + \dots + \lambda_n v_n : \lambda_i \in \mathbb{C}\}.$$

Example. Let $v_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$, $v_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ i \end{pmatrix} \in \mathbb{C}^2$. Then $\lambda_1 v_1 + \lambda_2 v_2 = \begin{pmatrix} \lambda_1 \\ i\lambda_2 \end{pmatrix}$. Since λ_1 and $i\lambda_2$ can be any complex number, $\text{span}_{\mathbb{C}}(v_1, v_2) = \mathbb{C}^2$.

3.2.3 Standard Basis

Definition 23 (Standard basis of $\mathbb{R}^n$). *The standard basis is $\{e_1, \dots, e_n\}$, where e_i has a 1 in the i -th coordinate and 0 elsewhere:*

$$e_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad e_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \dots, \quad e_n = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Equivalently, $e_1, \dots, e_n$ are the columns of I_n .

Proposition 1. *Every $x \in \mathbb{R}^n$ can be written uniquely as $x = x_1 e_1 + \dots + x_n e_n$.*⁹

The standard basis also clarifies the difference between real and complex vector spaces — the same vectors generate very different spans depending on the scalar field.

Example (Real vs complex span). *Using e_1, e_2 in $\mathbb{C}^2$: over field $\mathbb{C}$, $\text{span}_{\mathbb{C}}(e_1, e_2) = \mathbb{C}^2$ with $\dim_{\mathbb{C}} \mathbb{C}^2 = 2$. Over field $\mathbb{R}$, e_1, e_2 cannot produce vectors with imaginary parts. To span $\mathbb{C}^2$ over $\mathbb{R}$, we also need ie_1, ie_2 , so $\text{span}_{\mathbb{R}}(e_1, e_2, ie_1, ie_2)$, giving*

$$\dim_{\mathbb{R}} \mathbb{C}^2 = 4.$$

3.3 Examples of Vector Spaces

3.3.1 Coordinate Spaces

Definition 24 (Coordinate space).

$$k^n = \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ \vdots \\ x_n \end{pmatrix} \mid x_i \in k \right\}, \quad \dim k^n = n.$$

Standard basis: $\{e_1, \dots, e_n\}$.

3.3.2 Polynomial Spaces

Definition 25 (Polynomial space).

$$P_n(k) = \{a_n x^n + \dots + a_1 x + a_0 \mid a_i \in k\}, \quad \dim P_n(k) = n + 1.$$

Standard basis: $\{1, x, x^2, \dots, x^n\}$, with $P_n(k) \cong k^{n+1}$. The isomorphism is simply the map that reads off the coefficients:

$$a_0 + a_1 x + \dots + a_n x^n \longleftrightarrow \begin{pmatrix} a_0 \\ a_1 \\ \vdots \\ a_n \end{pmatrix}.$$

⁹To verify the standard basis is indeed a basis, see Appendix 9.1.

A polynomial is completely determined by its $n + 1$ coefficients, so it carries exactly the same information as a vector in k^{n+1} .

Example. $1 + x^2 \in P_2(\mathbb{R})$, which has standard basis $\{1, x, x^2\}$ and $\dim P_2(\mathbb{R}) = 3$.

$1 + ix^3 \in P_3(\mathbb{C})$, which has standard basis $\{1, x, x^2, x^3\}$ and $\dim P_3(\mathbb{C}) = 4$.

Remark 8. The space of all polynomials $P_\infty(k) = \{a_0 + a_1x + \cdots : a_i \in k\}$ is infinite-dimensional, and the spaces form a nested sequence

$$P_0(k) \subseteq P_1(k) \subseteq \cdots \subseteq P_\infty(k).$$

3.3.3 Matrix Spaces

Definition 26 (Matrix space).

$$M_n(k) = \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} a_{11} & \cdots & a_{1n} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ a_{n1} & \cdots & a_{nn} \end{pmatrix} \mid a_{ij} \in k \right\}, \quad \dim M_n(k) = n^2.$$

Standard basis: $\{e_{ij} : 1 \leq i, j \leq n\}$, where e_{ij} has a 1 in the (i, j) -th entry and 0 elsewhere.

Example. In $M_2(\mathbb{R})$: $\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 3 & 4 \end{pmatrix} = 1e_{11} + 2e_{12} + 3e_{21} + 4e_{22}$.

3.3.4 Function Spaces

Definition 27 (Function space). Let D be a set and k a field. Define

$$F(D, k) = \{f : D \rightarrow k\},$$

with pointwise operations $(f + g)(x) = f(x) + g(x)$ and $(\lambda f)(x) = \lambda f(x)$. This is a vector space over k .

Finite case. If $D = \{1, \dots, n\}$, define the Kronecker delta functions

$$\delta_i(j) = \begin{cases} 1, & i = j, \\ 0, & i \neq j. \end{cases}$$

Then $\{\delta_1, \dots, \delta_n\}$ is a basis of $F(D, k)$ and every f can be written uniquely as $f = \sum_{i=1}^n f(i) \delta_i$. Hence $\dim F(D, k) = n$.

Infinite case. If D is infinite, $F(D, k)$ is infinite-dimensional: there is no finite spanning set. The natural candidate for a basis, $\{\delta_x : x \in D\}$, is linearly independent but fails to span because linear combinations must be finite — a general $f : D \rightarrow k$ can be nonzero at infinitely many points and cannot be expressed as a finite sum of δ_x 's.

Example. Let $D = \{1, 2, 3\}$, $k = \mathbb{R}$, and f with $f(1) = 2$, $f(2) = -1$, $f(3) = 3$. The standard basis is $\{\delta_1, \delta_2, \delta_3\}$ and $f = 2\delta_1 - \delta_2 + 3\delta_3$.

3.4 Subspaces

3.4.1 Definition and the Subspace Criterion

Definition 28 (Subspace). *A subspace of V is a subset $U \subseteq V$ that is itself a vector space over the same field k .*

Proposition 2 (Subspace criterion). *$U \subseteq V$ is a subspace if and only if:*

1. $0 \in U$,
2. $u, v \in U \Rightarrow u + v \in U$,
3. $u \in U, \lambda \in k \Rightarrow \lambda u \in U$.

Remark 9 (Proving a vector space in practice). *To prove that a set U is a vector space over k , you do **not** always need to verify all 10 axioms. If U is a subset of an already-known vector space V over the same field k , then 7 of the 10 axioms are inherited automatically from V . In that case, it suffices to verify only the 3 subspace criteria. The full 10-axiom verification is only necessary when constructing a completely new vector space with no ambient space to inherit from.*

Example (Proving a subspace with the 3-criteria). *Let $V = \mathbb{R}^3$ and $U = \{(x, y, z) \in \mathbb{R}^3 : x + y + z = 0\}$. Prove U is a subspace. Since $U \subset \mathbb{R}^3$, we only check the 3 criteria.*

1. **Zero:** $0 + 0 + 0 = 0$, so $(0, 0, 0) \in U$. ✓
2. **Addition:** Let $u = (x_1, y_1, z_1), v = (x_2, y_2, z_2) \in U$. Then

$$(x_1 + x_2) + (y_1 + y_2) + (z_1 + z_2) = (x_1 + y_1 + z_1) + (x_2 + y_2 + z_2) = 0.$$
 so $u + v \in U$. ✓
3. **Scalar mult:** $(\lambda x) + (\lambda y) + (\lambda z) = \lambda(x + y + z) = 0$, so $\lambda u \in U$. ✓

Hence U is a subspace of $\mathbb{R}^3$. Note that U is a plane through the origin.

Problem 7 (Subspace criterion). *Let $A \in M_n(k)$. Prove that $U = \{x \in k^n : Ax = \vec{0}\}$ is a subspace (the null space or kernel of A).*

Problem 8 (Subspace criterion 2). *Let $A \in M_n(k)$. Show that $U = \{Ax \mid x \in k^n\}$ is a subspace of k^n (the image of A).*

Problem 9 (Subspace criterion 3). *Let $V = k$, viewed as a vector space over k . Show that the only subspaces are $\{0\}$ and V itself.*

Problem 10 (Subspace criterion 4). *Let $v_1, \dots, v_n \in V$. Show that $\text{span}(v_1, \dots, v_n)$ is a subspace of V .*

3.4.2 Membership in a Span

Problem 11 (Span membership). Let $v = \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 5 \\ -5 \end{pmatrix}$, $v_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$, $v_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 5 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix}$, $v_3 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 3 \\ 6 \end{pmatrix}$. Decide whether $v \in \text{span}(v_1, v_2, v_3)$.

Problem 12 (Span membership 2). Let $f = 3x^2 + 5x - 5$, $f_1 = x^2 + 2x + 1$, $f_2 = 2x^2 + 5x + 4$, $f_3 = x^2 + 3x + 6$. Decide whether $f \in \text{span}(f_1, f_2, f_3)$.

3.4.3 Operations on Subspaces

Let W be a vector space and $U, V \subseteq W$ subspaces.

Definition 29 (Intersection).

$$U \cap V = \{w \in W \mid w \in U \text{ and } w \in V\}.$$

The intersection of subspaces is a subspace; the smallest possible is $\{0\}$.

Definition 30 (Union).

$$U \cup V = \{w \in W \mid w \in U \text{ or } w \in V\}.$$

The union of subspaces is not necessarily a subspace.

Proposition 3. $U \cup V$ is a subspace of W if and only if $U \subseteq V$ or $V \subseteq U$.

Proof. If $U \subseteq V$, then $U \cup V = V$, a subspace. Conversely, if neither contains the other, pick $u \in U \setminus V$ and $v \in V \setminus U$. If $U \cup V$ were a subspace, $u + v \in U \cup V$. If $u + v \in U$, then $v = (u + v) - u \in U$, a contradiction. If $u + v \in V$, then $u = (u + v) - v \in V$, also a contradiction. $\square$

Definition 31 (Sum of subspaces).

$$U + V = \{u + v \mid u \in U, v \in V\}.$$

Proposition 4. If U and V are subspaces of W , then $U + V$ is a subspace of W .

Proof. Apply the subspace criterion: $0 = 0 + 0 \in U + V$; if $w_1 = u_1 + v_1$ and $w_2 = u_2 + v_2$ then $w_1 + w_2 = (u_1 + u_2) + (v_1 + v_2) \in U + V$; for $\lambda \in K$, $\lambda w = \lambda u + \lambda v \in U + V$. $\square$

Proposition 5. $U + V = \text{span}(U \cup V)$, i.e., $U + V$ is the smallest subspace containing both U and V .

Proof. ($\subseteq$): Any $u + v \in U + V$ with $u, v \in U \cup V$ lies in $\text{span}(U \cup V)$.

($\supseteq$): Any $w \in \text{span}(U \cup V)$ can be grouped as a sum of a U -part and a V -part, so $w \in U + V$. $\square$

January 23,
2026

3.4.4 Direct Sums

Definition 32 (Direct sum). *We say U and V are in direct sum if $U \cap V = \{0\}$, and write $U \oplus V$ for their sum. We write*

$$W = U \oplus V \iff \begin{cases} W = U + V, \\ U \cap V = \{0\}. \end{cases}$$

Proof. $W = U \oplus V$ iff every $w \in W$ decomposes *uniquely* as $w = u + v$. Uniqueness follows since $u_1 - u_2 = v_2 - v_1 \in U \cap V = \{0\}$ forces $u_1 = u_2$. Conversely, if decompositions are unique and $w \in U \cap V$, then $0 = w + (-w) = 0 + 0$ forces $w = 0$. $\square$

Analogy with sets.

Set Theory	Linear Algebra (Vector Spaces)
$A \cap B$	$U \cap V$
$A \cup B$	$U + V$
$A \sqcup B, A \cap B = \emptyset$	$U \oplus V, U \cap V = \{0\}$

Direct sums in function spaces.

Definition 33 (Support on a subset). *Let $A \subseteq D$. Define $U = \{f \in F(D, \mathbb{R}) : f(x) = 0 \forall x \notin A\}$. Then $U \cong F(A, \mathbb{R})$ is a subspace of $F(D, \mathbb{R})$.*

Example. *Let $D = \{1, 2, 3, 4, 5\}$, $A = \{2, 4\}$. Then $U = \{f : f(1) = f(3) = f(5) = 0\}$ is a 2-dimensional subspace, with each $f \in U$ determined by $(f(2), f(4))$.*

4 Basis and Dimension

January 26,
2026

4.1 Finite Dimensional Spaces

Let V be a vector space over a field k . Either $V = \{0\}$, or there exists $v_1 \neq 0$ in V . In the latter case, either $V = \text{span}(v_1)$, or there exists $v_2 \notin \text{span}(v_1)$, and so on. The maximum number of linearly independent vectors is the dimension of V .

Definition 34 (Finite dimensional vector space). *V is finite-dimensional if $\exists$ a finite set $v_1, \dots, v_n \in V$ with $V = \text{span}(v_1, \dots, v_n)$. Its dimension is*

$$\dim_k V = \min\{n : V = \text{span}_k(v_1, \dots, v_n)\}.$$

Example ($\mathbb{C}$ as a real vector space). $\dim_{\mathbb{R}} \mathbb{C} = 2$ (basis $\{1, i\}$). For $M_n(\mathbb{C})$: $\dim_{\mathbb{C}} M_n(\mathbb{C}) = n^2$ and $\dim_{\mathbb{R}} M_n(\mathbb{C}) = 2n^2$.

Example (P_{∞} is infinite-dimensional). *Since $x^{n+1} \notin P_n = \text{span}\{1, x, \dots, x^n\}$ for all n , the space $P_{\infty}(\mathbb{R})$ requires arbitrarily many basis vectors.*

Problem 13 (Infinite dimension of P_{∞}). *Prove that P_{∞} over any field k has infinite dimension.*

4.2 Linear Independence

Definition 35 (Linear independence). *Vectors $v_1, \dots, v_n$ are linearly independent (LI) if*

$$\lambda_1 v_1 + \dots + \lambda_n v_n = 0 \implies \lambda_1 = \dots = \lambda_n = 0.$$

Definition 36 (Linear dependence). *Linearly dependent (LD) is the negation of LI: there exist scalars, not all zero, with $\lambda_1 v_1 + \dots + \lambda_n v_n = 0$.*

Example. $e_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$, $e_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$ are LI: $xe_1 + ye_2 = \begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \end{pmatrix} = 0 \implies x = y = 0$.

Proposition 6. $v_1, \dots, v_n$ are LD if and only if one vector lies in the span of the others.

Proof. ($\Rightarrow$) If $\lambda_1 v_1 + \dots + \lambda_n v_n = 0$ with some $\lambda_k \neq 0$, then $v_k = \frac{-1}{\lambda_k} \sum_{i \neq k} \lambda_i v_i$.
 ($\Leftarrow$) If $v_k = \sum_{i \neq k} \lambda_i v_i$, rearranging gives a nontrivial relation. $\square$

Remark 10. If any vector $v_i = 0$, the family is LD.

Example. For $v_1 = \begin{pmatrix} a_1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$, $v_2 = \begin{pmatrix} b_1 \\ b_2 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$, $v_3 = \begin{pmatrix} c_1 \\ c_2 \\ c_3 \end{pmatrix}$, if $a_1, b_2, c_3 \neq 0$ then v_1, v_2, v_3 are LI (solved by back-substitution). If $c_3 = 0$, all vectors lie in a 2D subspace and are LD.

Problem 14 (Linear independence). Let $v_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$, $v_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 3 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}$, $v_3 = \begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ 9 \\ 5 \end{pmatrix}$.

Are these LI?

4.3 Basis

4.3.1 Definition and the Main Basis Theorem

Definition 37 (Basis). $(v_1, \dots, v_n)$ is a basis of V if it spans V and is linearly independent.

Remark 11. If V has a basis of n vectors, then $\dim V = n$.

Example (Standard basis of $\mathbb{R}^3$). $\{e_1, e_2, e_3\}$ is a basis of $\mathbb{R}^3$: it spans (any $v = xe_1 + ye_2 + ze_3$) and is LI (setting to zero gives $x = y = z = 0$).

Lemma 2. For $(v_1, \dots, v_n) \subset \mathbb{R}^k$: if $n < k$ the vectors cannot span $\mathbb{R}^k$; if $n > k$ they cannot be LI.

Lemma 3. If $u_1, \dots, u_n$ span V and $v_1, \dots, v_m$ are LI in V , then $n \geq m$.

Theorem 4 (Main Basis Theorem). $(v_1, \dots, v_n)$ in V are equivalent (these four properties are all secretly the same thing):

1. **Basis:** they span V and are LI.
2. **Minimal span:** they span V and no $m < n$ vectors span V .
3. **Maximal LI:** they are LI and no $m > n$ vectors are LI.
4. **Unique coordinates:** every $v \in V$ writes uniquely as $v = \sum_{i=1}^n \lambda_i v_i$.

Corollary 4.1. Any two bases of V have the same number of vectors. Hence $\dim V$ is well-defined.

Proof. If $(e_1, \dots, e_n)$ and $(f_1, \dots, f_m)$ are both bases, the two-way spanning/independence argument gives $n \geq m$ and $m \geq n$. $\square$

4.3.2 Finding a Basis

There are several methods depending on how the space is described.

Method 1: Extracting from a spanning set.

Use this when you are given explicit vectors in k^m and want to find which ones form a basis.

1. Form a matrix A whose *columns* are the vectors.
2. Row reduce A to echelon form.
3. The original vectors corresponding to pivot columns form a basis.

Problem 15 (Finding a Basis). Let V be the subspace of $\mathbb{R}^4$ spanned by $v_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$, $v_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 1 \\ 3 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}$, $v_3 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$, $v_4 = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 8 \\ 2 \\ 10 \end{pmatrix}$. Find a subset forming a basis of V .

Method 2: Testing linear independence.

Use this when the vectors live in an abstract space (matrices, polynomials) that you can flatten into coordinates.

1. Map each vector to its coordinate vector in k^n using a known isomorphism.
2. Set up $a_1 v_1 + \dots + a_n v_n = 0$ and solve.
3. Drop any vector whose coefficient is forced to be free (it is a linear combination of the others).

Problem 16 (Finding a Basis 2). Find a basis of the span of $M_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 1 & 3 \end{pmatrix}$, $M_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 3 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$, $M_3 = \begin{pmatrix} 4 & 5 \\ 5 & 7 \end{pmatrix}$ in $M_2(\mathbb{R})$.

Method 3: Constructing from the general form.

Use this when the subspace is defined by constraints (e.g. symmetry, zero entries). Write out the most general element satisfying the constraints and identify the free parameters — each gives one basis vector.

Problem 17 (Finding a Basis 3). (1) Show $A \in M_2(\mathbb{C})$ is Hermitian iff $A = \begin{pmatrix} x & z \\ \bar{z} & y \end{pmatrix}$ for $x, y \in \mathbb{R}, z \in \mathbb{C}$.
(2) Find a basis of the set U of all Hermitian matrices in $M_2(\mathbb{C})$, viewed as a real vector space.

Method 4: Bases of function spaces.

Use this when the space is $F(X)$ for a finite set X . The dimension equals the number of free values, and you verify a candidate basis by checking LI (evaluate at each point) and count.

Problem 18 (Finding a Basis 4). Let $X = \{-2, -1, 0, 1, 2\}$, $U = \{f \in F(X) : f(-x) = f(x) \forall x\}$. With $g_1(x) = 1$, $g_2(x) = \frac{1}{4}x^2(1 - x^2)$, $g_3(x) = \frac{1}{3}x^2(4 - x^2)$, prove $S = (g_1, g_2, g_3)$ is a basis of U .

4.3.3 Proving a Set Forms a Basis

Method 1 (Dimension test). $(v_1, \dots, v_n)$ is a basis of V iff $\dim(\text{span}(v_1, \dots, v_n)) = n$.

Proposition 7 (Basis criterion). If $\dim V = n$, then for $v_1, \dots, v_n \in V$, the following are equivalent: (1) basis, (2) spans V , (3) LI.

Proof. A spanning set of $n = \dim V$ vectors is minimal, hence LI. An independent set of n vectors is maximal, hence spans V . $\square$

Principle 1 (Transfer/Exchange principle). If $u_1, \dots, u_n$ span V and $v_1, \dots, v_n$ are LI, then both lists are bases of V .

Example. In P_n : $(1, x, \dots, x^n)$ spans and $((x-a)^0, \dots, (x-a)^n)$ is LI, so both are bases of P_n .

4.3.4 Basis Extension and Extraction

Theorem 5 (Basis extension). Let V be finite-dimensional and $v_1, \dots, v_m$ LI in V . Then they can be extended to a basis of V .

Proof. Set $U = \text{span}(v_1, \dots, v_m)$. If $U = V$, done. Otherwise pick $v_{m+1} \in V \setminus U$; this gives a larger LI set. Repeat until the span equals V , which happens after at most $\dim V - m$ steps. $\square$

Corollary 5.1 (Existence of Supplement). If $U \subseteq V$, then there exists a subspace U' of V such that $V = U \oplus U'$, U' is called supplement of U in V . U' is not unique

Theorem 6 (Basis extraction). *If $v_1, \dots, v_n$ span V , one can extract a basis from this list.*

Theorem 7 (Basis Juxtaposition). *If $U \oplus V = W$, $(e_1, \dots, e_n)$ is a basis of U and $(f_1, \dots, f_m)$ is a basis of V , then $(e_1, \dots, e_n, f_1, \dots, f_m)$ is a basis of $U \oplus V$.*

Problem 19 (Basis Extension). *Let V be a finite-dimensional vector space and $L \subseteq V$ linearly independent. Show there is a basis $B \supseteq L$ of V .*

4.4 Coordinates and Change of Basis

Theorem 8 (Unique coordinates). *Let $e_1, \dots, e_n$ be vectors in V . The following are equivalent:*

- *Basis : $e_1, \dots, e_n$ span V and are LI.*
- *Unique coordinates: every vectors $v \in V$ can be written as $v = \sum_i \lambda_i e_i$ in a unique way.*

4.4.1 Coordinate Vectors

Definition 38 (Coordinate vectors). *For basis $(v_1, \dots, v_n)$ of V , every $v = x_1 v_1 + \dots + x_n v_n$ uniquely, and $[v]_e = \begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ \vdots \\ x_n \end{pmatrix}$ is the coordinate vector of v .*

Example (Finding a coordinate vector). *Find the coordinate vector of $v = \begin{pmatrix} 5 \\ 3 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix}$*

in the basis $f = (f_1, f_2, f_3)$ where $f_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$, $f_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$, $f_3 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$.

We need x, y, z such that $xf_1 + yf_2 + zf_3 = v$. Writing this as a system:

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 \\ -1 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \\ z \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 5 \\ 3 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Row reduce the augmented matrix:

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 & 5 \\ -1 & 1 & 1 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 4 \end{pmatrix} \xrightarrow{R_2+R_1} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 & 5 \\ 0 & 2 & 1 & 8 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 4 \end{pmatrix} \xrightarrow{R_2-R_3} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 & 5 \\ 0 & 2 & 0 & 4 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 4 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Back-substitution: $z = 4$, $y = 2$, $x = 3$. Therefore $[v]_f = \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 2 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix}$.

Problem 20 (Coordinate vectors). Let $X = \{-2, -1, 0, 1, 2\}$, $U = \{f \in F(X) : f(-x) = f(x)\}$, with basis $S = (g_1, g_2, g_3)$ as above. Find $[g]_S$ for g with $g(\pm 2) = 3$, $g(\pm 1) = g(0) = 2$.

Problem 21 (Coordinate vectors 2). Let $D = \{1, 2, 3\}$. Find the coordinates of $f(x) = 2x^2 - 3$ in the standard basis of $F(D)$.

4.4.2 Direct Sum Decompositions and Dimension Formulas

Theorem 9 (Basis concatenation). If $V = U \oplus U'$ with bases $(e_1, \dots, e_n)$ and $(f_1, \dots, f_m)$ respectively, then $(e_1, \dots, e_n, f_1, \dots, f_m)$ is a basis of V and $\dim(U \oplus U') = \dim U + \dim U'$.

Proof. LI: $\sum a_i e_i + \sum b_j f_j = 0$ gives $w = \sum a_i e_i = -\sum b_j f_j \in U \cap U' = \{0\}$, forcing all $a_i = b_j = 0$. Span: every $v \in U + U'$ writes $v = u + u'$. $\square$

Theorem 10 (Dimension of sum).

$$\dim(U + U') = \dim U + \dim U' - \dim(U \cap U').$$

Corollary 10.1. If $U \subseteq V$, then $\dim U \leq \dim V$.

Corollary 10.2. If $U \subseteq V$, then U admits a complement: $\exists U' \subseteq V$ with $V = U \oplus U'$ and $\dim V = \dim U + \dim U'$.

5 Linear Transformations

5.1 Functions: Basic Definitions

Let U and V be sets. A transformation $T : U \rightarrow V$ assigns to each $u \in U$ a unique element $T(u) \in V$. The set U is the domain, V the codomain, and $\text{Im}(T) = \{T(u) : u \in U\} \subseteq V$ is the image.

Definition 39 (Injective, surjective, bijective).

- T is **surjective** if $\text{Im}(T) = V$, i.e., every element of V is hit by at least one element of U .
- T is **injective** if $T(u) = T(u') \implies u = u'$, where u' is any other element of U . In other words, no two distinct inputs give the same output — every element of V is hit by at most one element of U .
- T is **bijective** if it is both injective and surjective, i.e., every element of V is hit by exactly one element of U .

Definition 40 (Operator). An operator is a linear transformation of U into itself (i.e. $U \rightarrow U$).

Remark 12. An operator $T : U \rightarrow U$ has this following condition:

$$T \text{ is surjective} \iff T \text{ is injective} \iff T \text{ is bijective.}$$

Example. $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}, x \mapsto x^3$ is bijective: every real number has exactly one real cube root, so distinct inputs give distinct outputs (injective) and every output is achieved (surjective). On the other hand, $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}, x \mapsto x^2$ is neither: it is not injective since $(-2)^2 = 2^2 = 4$ (two inputs, same output), and not surjective since negative numbers are never achieved.

Example. $z \mapsto z^2$ on $\mathbb{C}$: not injective since $(-1)^2 = 1^2 = 1$ (so two distinct complex numbers map to the same value). It is however surjective: every $w \in \mathbb{C}$ has a square root in $\mathbb{C}$ by the Fundamental Theorem of Algebra, so every output is achieved.

5.1.1 Composition and Inverses

Definition 41 (Composition). Given $T : U \rightarrow V$ and $S : V \rightarrow W$, the composition $R = S \circ T : U \rightarrow W$ is defined by $R(u) = S(T(u))$.

Example. $g = \sin \circ (x^2) : \mathbb{R} \xrightarrow{x^2} \mathbb{R} \xrightarrow{\sin} \mathbb{R}$, so $g(x) = \sin(x^2)$.

Proposition 8 (Inverses). $T : U \rightarrow V$ is bijective if and only if T has an inverse $S : V \rightarrow U$ with $ST = \text{id}_U$ ¹⁰ and $TS = \text{id}_V$, where $\text{id}_U(u) = u$ and $\text{id}_V(v) = v$ are the identity maps¹¹.

5.2 Linear Maps

Definition 42 (Linear transformation). Let U, V be vector spaces over k . A map $T : U \rightarrow V$ is **linear** if:

1. Additive: $T(u + u') = T(u) + T(u')$,
2. Scalar: $T(\lambda u) = \lambda T(u)$ for all $\lambda \in k$.

5.2.1 Main Examples of Linear Maps

Matrix transformations

The primary example is $T_A : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^n, T_A(x) = Ax$ for a fixed $A \in M_n(\mathbb{R})$:

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 3 & 4 \end{pmatrix} \implies T_A \begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} x + 2y \\ 3x + 4y \end{pmatrix}.$$

T_A is bijective if and only if A is invertible ($\det(A) \neq 0$): if A^{-1} exists, then $T_{A^{-1}}$ is the inverse map, so every output has exactly one input. If $\det(A) = 0$, then $Ax = 0$ has a nonzero solution, meaning T_A collapses an entire direction to zero — it is neither injective (two inputs map to the same output) nor surjective (some outputs are never reached).

¹⁰remember ST means "apply T first, then S ."

¹¹The identity map sends every element to itself; it is the function analogue of the identity matrix.

Scaling

Definition 43 (Scaling transformation). $T : U \rightarrow U$ is called *scaling* if there exists a basis $(u_1, \dots, u_n)$ and scalars $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_n \in k$ such that $T(u_i) = \lambda_i u_i$ for all i .

T is bijective if all $\lambda_i \neq 0$: each basis vector is simply stretched or shrunk but never sent to zero, so distinct inputs stay distinct (injective) and every output is reachable by scaling back (surjective). If any $\lambda_i = 0$, then $T(u_i) = 0 = T(0)$, so two distinct vectors map to the same output — T is neither injective nor surjective.

The derivative

$$D : P_n \rightarrow P_n, \quad f \mapsto f', \quad D(x^k) = kx^{k-1}.$$

D is linear: $(f + g)' = f' + g'$ and $(\lambda f)' = \lambda f'$. D is not injective because any two polynomials differing by a constant have the same derivative, e.g. $D(1) = D(0) = 0$, so $\ker(D)$ contains all constants. D is not surjective because x^n is never achieved: differentiating any polynomial in P_n drops the degree by 1, so nothing in P_n can differentiate to x^n .

The indefinite integral

$$\int : P_\infty \rightarrow P_\infty \quad [\text{linear, injective, not surjective}].$$

Injective: integration raises the degree, so if $\int f = \int g$ then $f = g$ — no two distinct polynomials integrate to the same thing. Equivalently, $\ker(\int) = \{0\}$. Not surjective: the constant polynomial $1 \in P_\infty$ is never an output, since $\int f$ always has zero constant term (or more precisely, $\int f$ always has degree at least 1).

Projection

Suppose $V = U \oplus U'$. Every $v \in V$ writes uniquely as $v = u + u'$. Define $P(v) := u$.

Proposition 9. *The projection $P : V \rightarrow U$ along U' is linear, surjective, but not injective.*

Proof. Linearity: write $v_1 = u_1 + u'_1$ and $v_2 = u_2 + u'_2$. Then $P(v_1 + v_2) = u_1 + u_2 = P(v_1) + P(v_2)$. Scalar case is analogous. Surjective: any $u \in U$ satisfies $P(u) = u$ (since $u = u + 0$ with $0 \in U'$), so every element of U is hit. Not injective: any nonzero $u' \in U'$ satisfies $P(u') = 0 = P(0)$, so two distinct vectors map to the same output. $\square$

5.2.2 Defining a Linear Map by its Action on a Basis

Proposition 10. Let $(u_1, \dots, u_n)$ be a basis of U and $v_1, \dots, v_n$ arbitrary vectors in V . There exists a unique linear $T : U \rightarrow V$ with $T(u_i) = v_i$.

Proof. Existence: for any $u = \lambda_1 u_1 + \dots + \lambda_n u_n$, define $T(u) = \lambda_1 v_1 + \dots + \lambda_n v_n$. Linearity follows from uniqueness of coordinates.

Uniqueness: any linear T with $T(u_i) = v_i$ is forced on all u by linearity. $\square$

Proposition 11. If S, T are linear, then $S \circ T$ is linear.

5.3 Kernel and Image

Definition 44 (Kernel and image).

$$\ker(T) = \{u \in U : T(u) = 0\}, \quad \text{Im}(T) = \{T(u) : u \in U\} \subseteq V.$$

Proposition 12. $\ker(T) \subseteq U$ and $\text{Im}(T) \subseteq V$ are subspaces.

Proposition 13. T is injective $\iff \ker(T) = \{0\}$.

Proof. $(\Leftarrow)$ If $\ker(T) = \{0\}$ and $T(u) = T(u')$, then $T(u - u') = 0$, so $u - u' = 0$. $(\Rightarrow)$ Contrapositive: if $\exists u \neq 0$ with $T(u) = 0$, then $T(u) = T(0)$ with $u \neq 0$. $\square$

Remark 13. The kernel is only useful for linear T . For example, $\ker(\sin) = \{k\pi : k \in \mathbb{Z}\}$ is not a subspace.

Proposition 14. If $(e_1, \dots, e_n)$ is a basis of U , then $\text{Im}(T) = \text{span}(T(e_1), \dots, T(e_n))$.

Proof. Any $v = T(u) = T(\lambda_1 e_1 + \dots + \lambda_n e_n) = \lambda_1 T(e_1) + \dots + \lambda_n T(e_n) \in \text{span}(T(e_i))$. $\square$

5.3.1 Rank-Nullity Theorem

Theorem 11 (Rank-Nullity Theorem). Let $T : U \rightarrow V$ be a linear map with U finite-dimensional. Then

$$\dim \ker(T) + \dim \text{Im}(T) = \dim U.$$

Proof. Let $n = \dim U$, $k = \dim \ker(T)$, and let $(u_1, \dots, u_k)$ be a basis of $\ker(T)$. By basis extension, extend to a basis $(u_1, \dots, u_k, u_{k+1}, \dots, u_n)$ of U . We claim $(T(u_{k+1}), \dots, T(u_n))$ is a basis of $\text{Im}(T)$.

Span: Any $T(u) = T(\sum \lambda_i u_i) = \sum_{i=k+1}^n \lambda_i T(u_i)$ since $T(u_i) = 0$ for $i \leq k$.

LI: Suppose $\sum_{i=k+1}^n \lambda_i T(u_i) = 0$. Then $T(\sum_{i=k+1}^n \lambda_i u_i) = 0$, so $\sum_{i=k+1}^n \lambda_i u_i \in \ker(T) = \text{span}(u_1, \dots, u_k)$. Since $(u_1, \dots, u_n)$ is LI, all $\lambda_i = 0$.

Hence $\dim \text{Im}(T) = n - k$, which gives the result. $\square$

Remark 14. $\dim \text{Im}(T)$ is called the **rank** of T and $\dim \ker(T)$ the **nullity**. For a matrix $A \in M_{m \times n}(k)$, rank-nullity says: $\text{rank}(A) + \text{nullity}(A) = n$ (number of columns).

5.3.2 Examples of Kernel and Image

Example. For the projection $P : V \rightarrow U$ along U' : $\text{Im}(P) = U$ and $\ker(P) = U'$.

Example. $A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 3 & 4 \end{pmatrix}$, $T_A : \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$. Solving $\begin{cases} x + 2y = 0 \\ 3x + 4y = 0 \end{cases}$ gives $x = y = 0$, so $\ker(T_A) = \{0\}$ and T_A is injective.

Example. $A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 7 & 8 & 9 \end{pmatrix}$. Row reduction gives $\ker(T_A) = \text{span} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -2 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$.

5.4 Matrix of a Linear Transformation

February 20,
2026

Definition 45 (Matrix of T in basis e). Let $e = (e_1, \dots, e_n)$ be a basis of U . The matrix of $T : U \rightarrow U$ in basis e is

$$[T]_e = ([T(e_1)]_e, \dots, [T(e_n)]_e).$$

The columns are the coordinate vectors of the images of the basis vectors.

Example. For $T = T_A$ on $\mathbb{R}^2$ with the standard basis, $[T]_e = A$.

Example (Derivative matrix for P_2). Working in P_2 with basis $e = (1, x, x^2)$, every polynomial $a + bx + cx^2$ has coordinate vector $(a, b, c)^T$. To build $[D]_e$, apply D to each basis vector and write the result's coordinates as a column:

$$D(1) = 0 \rightarrow \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad D(x) = 1 \rightarrow \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad D(x^2) = 2x \rightarrow \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 2 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix},$$

so $[D]_e = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$. To verify: $f = 3 + 5x - 2x^2$ has $f' = 5 - 4x$, and indeed

$$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 5 \\ -2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 5 \\ -4 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \longleftrightarrow 5 - 4x. \checkmark$$

Example (Matrix of T in a non-standard basis). Let $T : \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$ be defined by $T \begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 3x + y \\ x + 3y \end{pmatrix}$, and let $f = (f_1, f_2)$ with $f_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$, $f_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix}$. Find $[T]_f$.

Column 1. $T(f_1) = \begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix} = 4f_1 + 0f_2$, so $[T(f_1)]_f = \begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$.

Column 2. $T(f_2) = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ -2 \end{pmatrix} = 0f_1 + 2f_2$, so $[T(f_2)]_f = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}$.

Therefore $[T]_f = \begin{pmatrix} 4 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 \end{pmatrix}$, which is diagonal. f_1 and f_2 are eigenvectors of T with eigenvalues 4 and 2.

6 Isomorphisms and Coordinates

Definition 46 (Isomorphism). $T : U \rightarrow V$ is an isomorphism if it is linear and bijective.

Remark 15 (How to check T is an isomorphism). In practice, verify the following three things:

1. **Linearity**: check $T(u + u') = T(u) + T(u')$ and $T(\lambda u) = \lambda T(u)$.
2. **Injectivity**: show $\ker(T) = \{0\}$, i.e., the only solution to $T(u) = 0$ is $u = 0$. This is equivalent to saying T does not collapse any nonzero vector to zero.
3. **Surjectivity**: show $\text{Im}(T) = V$, i.e., every $v \in V$ can be written as $T(u)$ for some $u \in U$.

A useful shortcut: if $\dim U = \dim V = n$, you only need to check linearity and one of injectivity or surjectivity — the other follows automatically by rank-nullity.

Theorem 12 (Properties of Isomorphisms). Let $T : V \rightarrow V$ be a linear map and let $A = [T]_e$ be the matrix of T in some basis e of V . Then the following are equivalent:

1. T is an isomorphism.
2. A is invertible.
3. $\det(A) \neq 0$.

Theorem 13 (Isomorphism Theorem). $U \cong V \iff \dim U = \dim V$. In particular, every n -dimensional space is isomorphic to k^n .

Example. $P_8 \cong \mathbb{R}^9 \cong M_3(\mathbb{R})$ since all have dimension 9.

6.1 The Canonical Isomorphism

Definition 47 (Coordinate map). Given vectors $v_1, \dots, v_n \in V$, define $\Phi : k^n \rightarrow V$ by

$$\Phi \begin{pmatrix} \lambda_1 \\ \vdots \\ \lambda_n \end{pmatrix} = \lambda_1 v_1 + \dots + \lambda_n v_n.$$

Then $\text{Im}(\Phi) = \text{span}(v_1, \dots, v_n)$.

Theorem 14 (Isomorphism Theorem 2). Φ is an isomorphism $\iff (v_1, \dots, v_n)$ is a basis for V . In this case, $[v]_e = \Phi^{-1}(v)$.

Proof. Φ is surjective $\iff (v_1, \dots, v_n) \text{ span } V$; Φ is injective $\iff (v_1, \dots, v_n)$ are LI. $\square$

February 27
– March 13,
2026

6.2 Change of Basis

6.2.1 Change of Basis Matrix

Let $e = (e_1, \dots, e_n)$ and $f = (f_1, \dots, f_n)$ be two bases of V , and let M_e and M_f denote the matrices whose columns are the basis vectors of e and f written in standard coordinates. The change of basis matrices are:

- $Q = M_e^{-1}M_f$: converts f -coordinates to e -coordinates.
- $P = M_f^{-1}M_e = Q^{-1}$: converts e -coordinates to f -coordinates.

Remark 16. When e is the standard basis, $M_e = I$, so the formulas simplify to $Q = M_f$ and $P = M_f^{-1}$.

Example (Building Q when neither basis is standard). Let $e = \left(\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \right)$ and $f = \left(\begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \right)$. Find Q .

$$M_e = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad M_f = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad M_e^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

$$Q = M_e^{-1}M_f = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad P = Q^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

6.2.2 Change of Basis Formula

Theorem 15 (Change of basis). If $A = [T]_e$ and $B = [T]_f$, then

$$B = PAQ, \quad P = Q^{-1}.$$

Remark 17 (The $Q^{-1}AQ$ shortcut). Since $P = Q^{-1}$, the formula is exactly $B = Q^{-1}AQ$. In practice: build Q (columns = new basis vectors, or $M_e^{-1}M_f$ in general), then compute $Q^{-1}AQ$.

Example (Full change of basis computation). Let e be the standard basis of $\mathbb{R}^2$, $f_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix}$, $f_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 5 \end{pmatrix}$, and $T : \begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \end{pmatrix} \mapsto \begin{pmatrix} 2x - 7y \\ 4x - 3y \end{pmatrix}$. Find $[T]_f$.

Step 1: $Q = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 3 & 5 \end{pmatrix}$.

Step 2: $P = Q^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} -5 & 2 \\ 3 & -1 \end{pmatrix}$.

Step 3:

$$AQ = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & -7 \\ 4 & -3 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 3 & 5 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} -19 & -31 \\ -5 & -7 \end{pmatrix}, \quad B = PAQ = \begin{pmatrix} 85 & 141 \\ -52 & -86 \end{pmatrix}.$$

March 13–16,
2026

7 Diagonalization

7.1 Eigenvalues and Eigenvectors

Definition 48 (Eigenvalue and eigenvector). $\lambda \in k$ is an eigenvalue of T if $\exists v \neq 0$ with $Tv = \lambda v$; v is an eigenvector. The eigenspace is

$$E_\lambda = \{v \in V : Tv = \lambda v\}.$$

Proposition 15. E_λ is a subspace of V .

Proposition 16. If $\lambda_1 \neq \lambda_2$, then $E_{\lambda_1} \cap E_{\lambda_2} = \{0\}$.

Proof. If $v \in E_{\lambda_1} \cap E_{\lambda_2}$, then $\lambda_1 v = Tv = \lambda_2 v$, so $(\lambda_1 - \lambda_2)v = 0$. Since $\lambda_1 \neq \lambda_2$, we get $v = 0$. $\square$

7.2 The Characteristic Polynomial

Definition 49 (Characteristic polynomial).

$$p(\lambda) = \det(A - \lambda \text{Id}).$$

Theorem 16 (Characterization of Eigenvalues). λ is an eigenvalue of $A \iff \lambda$ is a root of $p(\lambda)$.

7.3 Algebraic and Geometric Multiplicity

Definition 50 (Algebraic and geometric multiplicity). For an eigenvalue λ of A :

- The algebraic multiplicity (AM) of λ is its exponent as a root of $p(\lambda)$.
- The geometric multiplicity (GM) of λ is $\dim E_\lambda = \dim \ker(A - \lambda \text{Id})$.

Theorem 17 (AM-GM inequality). For every eigenvalue λ :

$$1 \leq \text{GM}(\lambda) \leq \text{AM}(\lambda).$$

A is diagonalizable $\iff \text{GM}(\lambda) = \text{AM}(\lambda)$ for every eigenvalue, i.e.,

$$V = E_{\lambda_1} \oplus E_{\lambda_2} \oplus \cdots \oplus E_{\lambda_k}.$$

Remark 18. In particular, if A has n distinct eigenvalues (all $\text{AM} = 1$), then A is automatically diagonalizable.

March 18,
2026

7.4 Diagonalization

Definition 51 (Diagonalizable). T (or its matrix A) is diagonalizable if $\exists$ a basis $e = (e_1, \dots, e_n)$ and scalars $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_n$ with $T(e_i) = \lambda_i e_i$.

Method 2 (How to diagonalize A). 1. Compute $p(\lambda) = \det(A - \lambda \text{Id})$ and find its roots (the eigenvalues).

2. For each eigenvalue λ_i , find $\ker(A - \lambda_i \text{Id})$ to get eigenvectors.

3. If there are n linearly independent eigenvectors, write them as columns of Q ; then $Q^{-1}AQ$ is diagonal.

Example (Diagonalization of a 4×4 matrix). Diagonalize $A = \begin{pmatrix} 5 & -2 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 3 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 2 & 4 \end{pmatrix}$.

Characteristic polynomial. A is block diagonal:

$$p(\lambda) = (5 - \lambda)(3 - \lambda) \cdot [(1 - \lambda)(4 - \lambda) - 4] = \lambda(\lambda - 3)(\lambda - 5)^2.$$

Eigenvalues: $\lambda = 0$ ($AM=1$), $\lambda = 3$ ($AM=1$), $\lambda = 5$ ($AM=2$).

Eigenvectors: For $\lambda = 5$: $E_5 = \text{span} \left(\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix} \right)$ ($GM=2=AM \checkmark$). For

$\lambda = 3$: $E_3 = \text{span} \left(\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \right)$. For $\lambda = 0$: $E_0 = \text{span} \left(\begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ -2 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \right)$.

$$P = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & -2 \\ 0 & 2 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad P^{-1}AP = \begin{pmatrix} 5 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 5 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 3 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Example (3×3 diagonalization). Let $A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 2 \\ 3 & 4 & 3 \\ 2 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$. Expanding along the second column:

$$p(\lambda) = (4 - \lambda) \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 - \lambda & 2 \\ 2 & 1 - \lambda \end{pmatrix} = (4 - \lambda)(\lambda - 3)(\lambda + 1).$$

Three distinct eigenvalues $\Rightarrow$ diagonalizable. Eigenvectors: $f_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$, $f_2 =$

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -6 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, f_3 = \begin{pmatrix} -1 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

$$Q = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 & -1 \\ 1 & -6 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad D = \begin{pmatrix} 4 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 3 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad A = QDQ^{-1}.$$

7.5 Similar Matrices

Definition 52 (Similar matrices). *A and B are **similar** if there exists an invertible Q with $A = Q^{-1}BQ$.*

Problem 22 (Similar matrices have equal characteristic polynomials). *Let A be similar to B, i.e., $A = Q^{-1}BQ$ for some invertible Q. Prove $p_A = p_B$.*

Problem 23 (Characteristic polynomial and invertibility). *Let $A \in M_n(\mathbb{R})$ be non-invertible. Show $p(\lambda)$ has a root at $\lambda = 0$.*

8 Inner Product Spaces

March
2026

18,

An inner product space is a vector space V equipped with an inner product — a way to measure length, angle, and perpendicularity.

Let V be a vector space over $K = \mathbb{R}$ or $K = \mathbb{C}$. We aim to define:

1. the norm of a vector $v \in V$, which is a real number $\|v\|$ representing the length of v ;
2. what it means for two vector $u, v \in V$ to be perpendicular (or orthogonal), denoted $u \perp v$.

One can do both by means of an inner product on V . We explain the case $K = \mathbb{R}$ first.

8.1 Real Inner Products

Definition 53 (Euclidean Norm). *The Euclidean norm of a vector $v = \begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ \vdots \\ x_n \end{pmatrix}$ is*

$$\|v\| = \sqrt{x_1^2 + \cdots + x_n^2} = \sqrt{\langle v, v \rangle},$$

where $\langle v, v \rangle$ is the standard dot product of v with itself.

Example (Frobenius Norm on $M_n(\mathbb{R})$). *The matrix analogue of the Euclidean norm is the Frobenius norm. For $A = (a_{ij})$ and $B = (b_{ij})$ in $M_n(\mathbb{R})$, define the inner product $\langle A, B \rangle = \sum_{i,j} a_{ij}b_{ij}$, which induces the norm*

$$\|A\| = \sqrt{\langle A, A \rangle} = \sqrt{\sum_{i,j} a_{ij}^2}.$$

This is the direct analogue of the Euclidean norm, summing the squares of all entries instead of all components.

Definition 54 (Inner product). *Let V be a real vector space. An inner product on V is a map $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle : V \times V \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ satisfying:*

1. **Linearity on the left:** $\langle v_1 + v_2, w \rangle = \langle v_1, w \rangle + \langle v_2, w \rangle$ and $\langle \lambda v, w \rangle = \lambda \langle v, w \rangle$.
2. **Symmetry:** $\langle u, v \rangle = \langle v, u \rangle$.
3. **Positive definiteness:** $\langle v, v \rangle \geq 0$, and $\langle v, v \rangle = 0 \Rightarrow v = 0$.

A vector space with an inner product is called an **inner product space**.

Remark 19. By symmetry, linearity on the left implies linearity on the right: $\langle u, v_1 + v_2 \rangle = \langle u, v_1 \rangle + \langle u, v_2 \rangle$ and $\langle u, \lambda v \rangle = \lambda \langle u, v \rangle$.

Definition 55 (Norm and Perpendicularity). *Let $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle$ be an inner product on V .*

1. The norm of $v \in V$ is defined by

$$\|v\| := \sqrt{\langle v, v \rangle}.$$

2. We say that u and v are perpendicular or orthogonal and write $u \perp v$ if

$$\langle u, v \rangle = 0.$$

Remark 20 (Length vs Distances). *The norm of v represents the length of the vector v . To compute the distance d between two points u and v in V (extremities of vectors), one needs to compute:*

$$\text{dist}(u, v) = \|u - v\|$$

Example (Standard inner product on $\mathbb{R}^n$). *For $v = (x_1, \dots, x_n)^T$ and $w = (y_1, \dots, y_n)^T$, the dot product $\langle v, w \rangle = x_1 y_1 + \dots + x_n y_n$ is an inner product.*

Example (Function space inner product). *On $V = C^0([0, 1])$, define $\langle f, g \rangle = \int_0^1 f(x)g(x) dx$. This satisfies all three axioms; positive definiteness uses the fact that if $f^2 \geq 0$ is continuous and $\int f^2 = 0$, then $f = 0$ everywhere.*

Proposition 17 (Norm expansion). *For any $u, v \in V$:*

$$\|u + v\|^2 = \|u\|^2 + 2\langle u, v \rangle + \|v\|^2.$$

Proof. $\langle u + v, u + v \rangle = \langle u, u \rangle + \langle u, v \rangle + \langle v, u \rangle + \langle v, v \rangle = \|u\|^2 + 2\langle u, v \rangle + \|v\|^2. \quad \square$

Theorem 18 (Pythagoras). $u \perp v \iff \langle u, v \rangle = 0 \iff \|u \pm v\|^2 = \|u\|^2 + \|v\|^2.$

8.2 Complex inner products

Definition 56 (Inner product on $\mathbb{C}^n$). For $x, y \in \mathbb{C}^n$, define

$$\langle x, y \rangle = \sum_{i=1}^n x_i \overline{y_i}.$$

Then $\|x\|^2 = \sum_{i=1}^n |x_i|^2 \geq 0$, with equality iff $x = 0$.

Definition 57. An inner product on a complex vector space V is a function assigning a complex number $\langle u, v \rangle$ to $u, v \in V$: $V \times V \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$, $(u, v) \rightarrow \langle u, v \rangle$ satisfying:

1. **Linearity on the left:** $\langle v_1 + v_2, w \rangle = \langle v_1, w \rangle + \langle v_2, w \rangle$ and $\langle \lambda v, w \rangle = \lambda \langle v, w \rangle$, $\forall u, v, w \in V, \lambda \in \mathbb{C}$.
2. **Symmetry:** $\langle u, v \rangle = \overline{\langle v, u \rangle}$.
3. **Positive definiteness:** $\langle v, v \rangle \geq 0$, and $\langle v, v \rangle = 0 \Rightarrow v = 0$.

Proposition 18 (Complex symmetry). Complex inner products are skew-linear in the second variable. This is also called anti-linear and means

- $\langle w, u + v \rangle = \langle w, u \rangle + \langle w, v \rangle$
- $\langle w, \lambda u \rangle = \overline{\lambda} \langle w, u \rangle$

Definition 58 (Adjoint Matrix). Let $A \in M_n(\mathbb{C})$ be a complex matrix. The adjoint of A is the complex matrix $A^* \in M_n(\mathbb{C})$ defined by $A^* = \overline{A}^t$.

Theorem 19 (Adjoint Property of Inner Products). Let T be a linear transformation from an inner product space V to itself, and let $v, w \in V$. Then

$$\langle Tv, w \rangle = \langle v, T^*w \rangle.$$

Definition 59 (Core Adjoint and Inner Product Rules). Core Adjoint and Inner Product Rules, the main property is

$$\langle Tv, w \rangle = \langle v, T^*w \rangle.$$

8.3 Cauchy-Schwarz Inequality

Theorem 20 (Cauchy-Schwarz Inequality). For any u, v in an inner product space V :

$$|\langle u, v \rangle| \leq \|u\| \|v\|,$$

with equality if and only if u and v are linearly dependent.

Proof. If $v = 0$ both sides are 0. Otherwise, let $w = u - \frac{\langle u, v \rangle}{\|v\|^2} v$ (the component of u orthogonal to v). Then $\langle w, v \rangle = 0$, and by positive definiteness:

$$0 \leq \|w\|^2 = \left\| u - \frac{\langle u, v \rangle}{\|v\|^2} v \right\|^2 = \|u\|^2 - \frac{|\langle u, v \rangle|^2}{\|v\|^2},$$

which rearranges to $|\langle u, v \rangle|^2 \leq \|u\|^2 \|v\|^2$. □

Theorem 21 (Triangle inequality). $\|u + v\| \leq \|u\| + \|v\|$.

Proof. $\|u + v\|^2 = \|u\|^2 + 2\langle u, v \rangle + \|v\|^2 \leq \|u\|^2 + 2\|u\|\|v\| + \|v\|^2 = (\|u\| + \|v\|)^2$. □

8.4 Orthonormal Bases

Definition 60 (Orthogonal). A family $v_1, \dots, v_n$ of vectors is orthogonal if

$$\langle v_i, v_j \rangle = 0, \text{ if } i \neq j.$$

Definition 61 (Orthonormal). A family $v_1, \dots, v_n$ of vectors is orthonormal if it is orthogonal and $\|v_i\| = 1, \forall i = 1, \dots, n$. Basically,

$$\langle v_i, v_j \rangle = \delta_{ij}$$

Definition 62 (Orthonormal Basis). An orthonormal basis (ONB) is a basis which is orthonormal.

Proposition 19. Any orthogonal set of nonzero vectors is linearly independent.

Proof. Suppose $\sum \lambda_i e_i = 0$. Taking the inner product with e_k :

$$0 = \left\langle e_k, \sum_i \lambda_i e_i \right\rangle = \lambda_k \|e_k\|^2,$$

so $\lambda_k = 0$ since $\|e_k\| \neq 0$. □

Proposition 20 (Coordinates in an ONB). If $(e_1, \dots, e_n)$ is an ONB of V , then for any $v \in V$:

$$v = \sum_{i=1}^n \langle v, e_i \rangle e_i.$$

In other words, the i -th coordinate of v in the ONB is simply $\langle v, e_i \rangle$.

Proof. Write $v = \sum \lambda_i e_i$. Taking $\langle \cdot, e_k \rangle$ of both sides: $\langle v, e_k \rangle = \lambda_k \|e_k\|^2 = \lambda_k$. □

Definition 63 (Orthogonal Matrix). A matrix $A \in M_n(\mathbb{R})$ is orthogonal if its columns form an ONB of $\mathbb{R}^n$ (endowed with the standard dot product).

Proposition 21. Let $TX = AX$ be the linear transformation of $\mathbb{R}^n$ associated with matrix $A \in M_n(\mathbb{R})$. Then A is an orthogonal matrix iff T preserves the dot product in the sense that:

$$\langle TX, TY \rangle = \langle X, Y \rangle,$$

for all vectors $X, Y \in \mathbb{R}^n$, where $\langle X, Y \rangle := X \cdot Y$ is the dot product.

Definition 64 (Orthogonal Matrix 2). A matrix A is said to be orthogonal if $AA^t = A^tA = Id$; equivalently, A is invertible with inverse $A^{-1} = A^t$.

Definition 65 (Unitary Matrix). A matrix $A \in M_n(\mathbb{C})$ is unitary if its columns form an ONB of $\mathbb{C}$.

Definition 66 (Unitary Matrix 2). A complex $A \in M_n(\mathbb{C})$ is unitary if $AA^* = A^*A = Id$; equivalently, A is invertible with inverse $A^{-1} = A^*$.

Definition 67 (Orthogonal Complement). An orthogonal complement of a subspace $W \subseteq V$ is the set

$$W^\perp = \{v \in V : v \perp w, \forall w \in W\}.$$

Theorem 22 (The Dimension of an Orthogonal Complement). For any subspace $W \subseteq V$,

$$\dim(W) + \dim(W^\perp) = \dim(V).$$

8.5 Symmetric Matrices Are Diagonalizable

Theorem 23 (Spectral theorem - version 1). Symmetric matrices are diagonalizable.

Example. Let the matrix $A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$. Then A is symmetric and thus diagonalizable.

Theorem 24 (Spectral theorem - version 2). If $A \in M_n(\mathbb{R})$ is symmetric, then there exists an ONB of eigenvectors.

Lemma 25. If A is symmetric, and $\lambda_1 \neq \lambda_2$ are two different eigenvalues of A , then $E_{\lambda_1} \perp E_{\lambda_2}$.

Theorem 26 (Spectral theorem - version 3). If $A \in M_n(\mathbb{R})$ is symmetric, there exists an orthogonal matrix Q and a diagonal matrix D such that

$$A = QDQ^t.$$

March
2026

25,

8.6 Orthogonal Matrices in Dimension 2

Every 2×2 orthogonal matrix is one of two types: a rotation or a reflection.

Proposition 22. *Let $A \in M_2(\mathbb{R})$ be orthogonal. Then A is either a rotation*

$$R_\theta = \begin{pmatrix} \cos \theta & -\sin \theta \\ \sin \theta & \cos \theta \end{pmatrix}$$

about the origin by angle θ , or a reflection

$$S_\theta = \begin{pmatrix} \cos \theta & \sin \theta \\ \sin \theta & -\cos \theta \end{pmatrix}$$

across a line through the origin at angle $\theta/2$. In symbols:

$$O(2) = \{R_\theta : \theta \in \mathbb{R}\} \cup \{S_\theta : \theta \in \mathbb{R}\}.$$

Remark 21. *You can tell them apart by the determinant:*

$$\det(R_\theta) = \cos^2 \theta + \sin^2 \theta = 1, \quad \det(S_\theta) = -\cos^2 \theta - \sin^2 \theta = -1.$$

So rotations have determinant 1 and reflections have determinant -1 .

Remark 22 (Exam tip). *The inverse of any orthogonal matrix is just its transpose: $A^{-1} = A^T$. No row reduction needed. In particular, $R_\theta^{-1} = R_{-\theta}$ (rotate back) and $S_\theta^{-1} = S_\theta$ (reflecting twice gives the identity).*

8.7 Isomorphism Theorem For Inner Product Spaces

Theorem 27 (Isomorphism Theorem For Inner Product Spaces). *Every finite-dimensional inner product space admits an ONB.*

Theorem 28. *Every inner product on a finite-dimensional space over K is isomorphic to the standard dot product on K^n .*

8.8 Gram-Schmidt Orthonormalization

Given two linearly independent vectors v_1, v_2 , Gram-Schmidt produces an ONB $\{e_1, e_2\}$ with $\text{span}(e_1, e_2) = \text{span}(v_1, v_2)$ in two steps:

1. Normalize v_1 : set $e_1 = \frac{v_1}{\|v_1\|}$.
2. Subtract from v_2 its projection onto e_1 , then normalize:

$$w_2 = v_2 - \langle v_2, e_1 \rangle e_1, \quad e_2 = \frac{w_2}{\|w_2\|}.$$

The key idea is that $\langle v_2, e_1 \rangle$ is the projection coefficient, telling you how much of v_1 's direction is in v_2 . Subtracting it off leaves a vector orthogonal to e_1 .

Example. Let $v_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 5 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$ and $v_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}$.

Step 1: $e_1 = \frac{v_1}{\|v_1\|} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$.

Step 2: $\langle v_2, e_1 \rangle = 3 \cdot 1 + 2 \cdot 0 = 3$, so

$$w_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix} - 3 \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}, \quad e_2 = \frac{w_2}{\|w_2\|} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

So $\{e_1, e_2\} = \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \right\}$ is an ONB for $\mathbb{R}^2$.

9 Appendix

9.1 Proof: Standard Basis is a Basis

Claim 1. $e_1, \dots, e_n$ span $\mathbb{R}^n$.

Proof. $\begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ \vdots \\ x_n \end{pmatrix} = x_1 e_1 + \dots + x_n e_n.$ □

Claim 2. $e_1, \dots, e_n$ are linearly independent.

Proof. $\lambda_1 e_1 + \dots + \lambda_n e_n = 0 \implies \begin{pmatrix} \lambda_1 \\ \vdots \\ \lambda_n \end{pmatrix} = 0 \implies \lambda_i = 0.$ □

10 Solutions

Solution 1 (Hermitian Matrix). $(AB)^* = (\overline{AB})^T = (\overline{A} \overline{B})^T = \overline{B}^T \overline{A}^T = B^* A^*.$

Solution 2 (Hermiticity and Anti-Hermiticity). $(\Rightarrow)$: Suppose A is Hermitian, then $A = \overline{A}^t$, then $(iA)^* = \overline{iA}^t = -iA^* = -iA$. Therefore, $-(iA)^* = iA$.

$(\Leftarrow)$: Suppose $iA = -(iA)^*$, then $iA = -(iA)^* = -(-iA^*) = iA^* = iA$. Therefore, $iA^* = iA \implies A = A^*.$

Solution 3 (Invertibility). Suppose B and B' are both inverses of A . Then $B = BI = B(AB') = (BA)B' = IB' = B'.$

Solution 4 (Invertibility 2). Suppose the matrix is invertible. Then $\det \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} = 0 \cdot 0 - 1 \cdot 0 = 0$, but an invertible matrix must have nonzero determinant. Contradiction.

Solution 5 (Span). $\text{span}(v_1, v_2) = \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} 3x + y \\ x + 3y \end{pmatrix} : x, y \in \mathbb{R} \right\}.$

Solution 6 (Span 2). Setting up $u = au_1 + bu_2 + cu_3$ gives the augmented matrix $\left(\begin{array}{ccc|c} 3 & 1 & 2 & 2 \\ 10 & 3 & 8 & 10 \\ 7 & -2 & 1 & 7 \end{array}\right)$. Gaussian elimination gives $a = \frac{2}{21}$, $b = -\frac{46}{21}$, $c = \frac{41}{21}$, so $u \in \text{span}(u_1, u_2, u_3)$.

Solution 7 (Subspace criterion). $U = \{x \in k^n : Ax = 0\}$. Check: $A0 = 0$ so $0 \in U$; if $Ax = Ay = 0$ then $A(x + y) = 0$; if $Ax = 0$ then $A(\lambda x) = 0$. So U is a subspace.

Solution 8 (Subspace criterion 2). $U = \{Ax : x \in k^n\}$. Check: $A0 = 0$; $Ax_1 + Ax_2 = A(x_1 + x_2)$; $\lambda Ax = A(\lambda x)$. So U is a subspace.

Solution 9 (Subspace criterion 3). If $V \neq \{0\}$, pick $v \in V$, $v \neq 0$. For any $x \in k$, write $x = \lambda v$ for $\lambda = x/v \in k$. By closure under scalar multiplication, $x \in V$. Hence $V = k$.

Solution 10 (Subspace criterion 4). $0 = 0v_1 + \cdots + 0v_n \in \text{span}$; sums and scalar multiples of linear combinations are linear combinations. Hence $\text{span}(v_1, \dots, v_n)$ is a subspace.

Solution 11 (Span membership). $x = 3$, $y = 1$, $z = -2$, so $v = 3v_1 + v_2 - 2v_3 \in \text{span}(v_1, v_2, v_3)$.

Solution 12 (Span membership 2). Same system: $t = 3$, $y = 1$, $z = -2$, so $f = 3f_1 + f_2 - 2f_3$.

Solution 13 (Infinite dimension of P_∞). If $\dim P_\infty < \infty$, some $f_1, \dots, f_n$ span P_∞ . Let $d = \max \deg(f_i)$. Then every polynomial in the span has degree $\leq d$, but x^{d+1} does not. Contradiction.

Solution 14 (Linear independence). $3v_1 + 5v_2 - 2v_3 = 0$, so the vectors are not LI.

Solution 15 (Finding a Basis). Form the matrix with v_1, v_2, v_3, v_4 as columns and row reduce:

$$\left(\begin{array}{cccc} 1 & 2 & 1 & 2 \\ 2 & 1 & 2 & 8 \\ 1 & 3 & 0 & 2 \\ 1 & 2 & 1 & 10 \end{array}\right) \longrightarrow \left(\begin{array}{cccc} 1 & 2 & 1 & 2 \\ 0 & -3 & 0 & 4 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 8 \end{array}\right) \longrightarrow \left(\begin{array}{cccc} 1 & 2 & 1 & 2 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & -3 & 4 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 8 \end{array}\right).$$

Pivots are in columns 1, 2, 3, 4, so all four vectors are LI and $\{v_1, v_2, v_3, v_4\}$ is a basis of V .

Solution 16 (Finding a Basis 2). Use the isomorphism $\begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \mapsto \begin{pmatrix} a \\ b \\ c \\ d \end{pmatrix}$ to get

coordinate vectors $\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ 1 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 1 \\ 3 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ 5 \\ 5 \\ 7 \end{pmatrix}$. Row reducing the matrix with these as

columns gives a free variable for M_3 , revealing $M_3 = 2M_1 + M_2$. So $\{M_1, M_2\}$ is a basis.

Solution 17 (Finding a Basis 3). (1) $A = A^*$ means $a_{ij} = \overline{a_{ji}}$. The diagonal entries satisfy $a_{ii} = \overline{a_{ii}}$, so they are real. The off-diagonal entries satisfy $a_{12} = \overline{a_{21}}$. Writing $z = a_{12}$ gives the form $\begin{pmatrix} x & z \\ \bar{z} & y \end{pmatrix}$.

(2) Writing $z = a + bi$ with $a, b \in \mathbb{R}$, the general Hermitian matrix is

$$x \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} + y \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} + a \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} + b \begin{pmatrix} 0 & i \\ -i & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

These four matrices are LI and span U , so they form a basis. Hence $\dim_{\mathbb{R}} U = 4$.

Solution 18 (Finding a Basis 4). Since $f \in U$ is even, it is determined by its values at $x = 0, 1, 2$, so $\dim U = 3$. It suffices to show S is LI (then $|S| = \dim U = 3$ implies it is a basis). Suppose $c_1g_1 + c_2g_2 + c_3g_3 = 0$. Evaluating:

$$x = 0 : c_1 = 0, \quad x = 1 : c_1 + 0 + c_3 = 0 \implies c_3 = 0, \quad x = 2 : c_1 + 0 + 0 = 0.$$

(One checks $g_2(1) = 0, g_2(2) = 0, g_3(1) = 1, g_3(2) = 0$.) Hence $c_1 = c_2 = c_3 = 0$ and S is LI, so S is a basis.

Solution 19 (Coordinate vectors). $\lambda_1 = 2, \lambda_3 = 0, \lambda_2 = -\frac{1}{3}$. So $[g]_S = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ -1/3 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$.

Solution 20 (Coordinate vectors 2). Evaluate: $f(1) = -1, f(2) = 5, f(3) = 15$. So $[f]_e = \begin{pmatrix} -1 \\ 5 \\ 15 \end{pmatrix}$.

Solution 21 (Basis Extension). If L spans V , done. Otherwise, since L is LI but not spanning, there exists $v_1 \in V \setminus \text{span}(L)$. Then $L \cup \{v_1\}$ is LI. Repeating: at each step we add one vector to L while maintaining LI. Since V is finite-dimensional, this process terminates in at most $\dim V - |L|$ steps, yielding a basis $B \supseteq L$.

Solution 22 (Similar matrices have equal characteristic polynomials). $p_A(\lambda) = \det(A - \lambda I) = \det(Q^{-1}BQ - \lambda I) = \det(Q^{-1}(B - \lambda I)Q) = \det(Q^{-1}) \det(B - \lambda I) \det(Q) = p_B(\lambda)$.

Solution 23 (Characteristic polynomial and invertibility). $\det(A) = 0$ since A is non-invertible, so $p(0) = \det(A - 0 \cdot I) = \det(A) = 0$. Hence 0 is a root of $p(\lambda)$.

11 Useful Links

Proofs: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=V5tUc-J124s>

Gram-Schmidt: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tu1GPtfsQ7M&t=393s>

Image and Kernel: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vyYrvhbDhW4>